

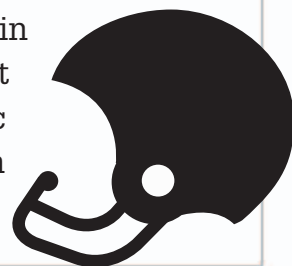


PROFESSIONAL ATHLETE

JOB DESCRIPTION

With the talent to be paid to practice their sport, professional athletes compete to achieve individual and team success and to entertain fans.

They work hard at training to stay in peak physical condition and perfect their skills. As well as their athletic duties, many professionals perform educational or charity work.



SALARY

Low-earning professional ★★★★★

Top-earning professional ★★★★★

INDUSTRY PROFILE

Extremely competitive, varied industry • Limited opportunities to reach highest level • Work may be part-time • Lucrative profession with international fame and wealth for successful athletes

AT A GLANCE



YOUR INTERESTS Competitive sport • Physical Education (PE) • Fitness • Health and nutrition • Business and marketing • Anatomy • Biology



ENTRY QUALIFICATIONS There are no minimum entry requirements to be a sportsperson, other than talent and dedication to a sport.



LIFESTYLE Hours of work may be long and irregular, with some form of training taking place most days. Competitions may occur on weekends and evenings.



LOCATION Sports professionals train and compete indoors and outdoors. Competitive events sometimes require national and international travel.



THE REALITIES Success can make this a highly rewarding and satisfying career, but many professional athletes have to supplement their income with other jobs.

RELATED CAREERS

► **PERSONAL TRAINER** *see pp. 300–301*

► **COMMUNITY SPORTS LEADER** Encourages public participation and access to sports and physical activity. Community sports leaders may work with specific groups, such as young or disabled people.

► **PHYSICAL EDUCATION TEACHER** Teaches a range of sports to young people at a school or college, promoting the benefits of physical activity and encouraging and developing sporting potential.

► **SPORTS PHYSICAL THERAPIST** Works with people with sports- or exercise-related injuries, improving their physical capabilities, providing advice on how to avoid further injury, and administering treatment to aid recovery. Sports physical therapists also diagnose injuries and recommend treatment programs using non-traditional methods of treatment, such as massage, heat treatment, or hydrotherapy.